Abe Dunn

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., University of Texas at Austin 2006
Dissertation: Empirical Essays on the Demand for Prescription Drugs
Committee Chair: Professor Ken Hendricks

M.S., University of Texas at Austin 2003

B.S., Economics and Mathematics, University of Oregon 2000

FIELDS

Health Economics, Industrial Organization, Economic Measurement, and Applied Econometrics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Chief Economist, Bureau of Economic Analysis 2016–present
Research Fellow, Department of Economics, University of Vienna 2026–present
Visiting Lecturer, Department of Economics, University of Vienna Spring 2025
Economist, Bureau of Economic Analysis 2010–2015
Economist, Antitrust Division, U.S. Department of Justice 2006–2010

PUBLICATIONS

Refereed Journal Articles

"US National Spending on Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Treatment Driven by Case Growth, 2000–21" (with Tami L. Mark, Lasanthi Fernando, and Peter Shieh). *Health Affairs*, 45(4): 365–371, 2026.

"The Value of Healthcare in the United States: Changes in Lifetime Spending and Health-Adjusted Life Expectancy, 1996 to 2016" (with Calvin Ackley, Esha Dwibedi, Lasanthi Fernando, Jonah Joffe, Justine Mallatt, Joseph L. Dieleman, and Marcia R. Weaver). *Value in Health*, 29(7), 2026.

"Expanding the Frontier of Economic Statistics Using Big Data: A Case Study of Regional Employment" (with Eric English, Kyle Hood, Lowell Mason, and Brian Quistorff). *Review of Income and Wealth*, 72(1): e70042, 2026.

"Economic Measurement Lost in a Random Forest? A Case Study of Employment Data" (with Eric English, Kyle Hood, Lowell Mason, and Brian Quistorff). *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 115: 68–72, 2025.

"The Geography of Consumption and Local Economic Shocks: The Case of the Great Recession" (with Mahsa Gholizadeh). *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*, 17(2): 206–244, 2025.

"Consumption Zones" (with Andrea Batch, Benjamin Bridgman, and Mahsa Gholizadeh). *Journal of Economic Geography*, 25(2): 191–213, 2025.

"A Denial a Day Keeps the Doctor Away" (with Joshua D. Gottlieb, Adam Hale Shapiro, Daniel J. Sonnenstuhl, and Pietro Tebaldi). *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 139(1): 187–233, 2024.

"Consumer Out-of-Pocket Drug Prices Grew Faster Than Prices Faced by Insurers After Accounting for Rebates, 2007–20" (with Justine Mallatt and Lasanthi Fernando). *Health Affairs*, 43(9): 1284–1289, 2024.

"Consequences of a Shortage and Rationing: Evidence from a Pediatric Vaccine" (with Eli Liebman, Emily C. Lawler, and David B. Ridley). *Journal of Health Economics*, 92: 102819, 2023.

"A Direct Measure of Medical Innovation on Health Care Spending: A Condition-Specific Approach" (with Lasanthi Fernando and Eli Liebman). *Health Management, Policy and Innovation*, 8(2), 2023.

"A Systematic Examination of Quality-Adjusted Price Index Alternatives for Medical Care Using Claims Data" (with Seidu Dauda and Anne Hall). *Journal of Health Economics*, 85: 102662, 2022.

"Are Medical Care Prices Still Declining? A Re-Examination Based on Cost-Effectiveness Studies" (with Anne Hall and Seidu Dauda). *Econometrica*, 90(2): 859–886, 2022.

"Health Care Spending Effectiveness: Estimates Suggest That Spending Improved US Health from 1996 to 2016" (with Marcia R. Weaver, Jonah Joffe, Michael Ciarametaro, Robert W. Dubois, Arjun Singh, Gianna W. Sparks, Lauryn Stafford, Christopher J. L. Murray, and Joseph L. Dieleman). *Health Affairs*, 41(7): 994–1004, 2022.

"Insurance Expansions and Hospital Utilization: Relabeling and Reabling?" (with Matthew Knepper and Seidu Dauda). *Journal of Health Economics*, 78: 102482, 2021.

"Measuring Consumer Spending Using Card Transaction Data: Lessons from the COVID-19 Pandemic" (with Kyle Hood, Andrea Batch, and Alexander Driessen). *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 111: 321–325, 2021.

"Administration above Administrators: The Changing Technology of Health Care Management" (with Joshua D. Gottlieb and Adam Hale Shapiro). *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 110: 274–278, 2020.

"US Health Care Spending by Payer and Health Condition, 1996–2016" (with Joseph L. Dieleman et al.). *JAMA*, 323(9): 863–884, 2020.

"Does Medicare Part D Save Lives?" (with Adam Hale Shapiro). *American Journal of Health Economics*, 5(1): 126–164, 2019.

"Productivity Growth of Skilled Nursing Facilities in the Treatment of Post-Acute-Care-Intensive Conditions" (with Jing Gu, Neeraj Sood, and John Romley). *PLOS ONE*, 14(4): e0215876, 2019.

"A Practical Guide to Episode Groupers for Cost-of-Illness Analysis in Health Services Research" (with Cora Peterson and Scott D. Grosse). *SAGE Open Medicine*, 7: 2050312119840200, 2019.

"High Spending Growth Rates for Key Diseases in 2000–14 Were Driven by Technology and Demographic Factors" (with Bryn Whitmire, Andrea Batch, Lasanthi Fernando, and Lindsey Rittmueller). *Health Affairs*, 37(6): 915–924, 2018.

"The Complexity of Billing and Paying for Physician Care" (with Joshua D. Gottlieb and Adam Hale Shapiro). *Health Affairs*, 37(4): 619–626, 2018.

"Physician Competition and the Provision of Care: Evidence from Heart Attacks" (with Adam Hale Shapiro). *American Journal of Health Economics*, 4(2): 226–261, 2018.

"Adjusting Health Expenditures for Inflation: A Review of Measures for Health Services Research in the United States" (with Scott D. Grosse and Samuel H. Zuvekas). *Health Services Research*, 53(1): 175–196, 2018.

"Guidelines for Measuring Disease Episodes: An Analysis of the Effects on the Components of Expenditure Growth" (with Eli Liebman, Lindsey Rittmueller, and Adam Hale Shapiro). *Health Services Research*, 52(2): 720–740, 2017.

"Health Insurance and the Demand for Medical Care: Instrumental Variable Estimates Using Health Insurer Claims Data." *Journal of Health Economics*, 48: 74–88, 2016.

"Health Care Spending Slowdown from 2000 to 2010 Was Driven by Lower Growth in Cost per Case, According to a New Data Source" (with Lindsey Rittmueller and Bryn Whitmire). *Health Affairs*, 35(1): 132–140, 2016.

"Implications of Utilization Shifts on Medical-Care Price Measurement" (with Eli Liebman and Adam Hale Shapiro). *Health Economics*, 24(5): 539–557, 2015.

"Physician Payments under Health Care Reform" (with Adam Hale Shapiro). *Journal of Health Economics*, 39: 89–105, 2015.

"Do Physicians Possess Market Power?" (with Adam Hale Shapiro). *Journal of Law and Economics*, 57(1): 159–193, 2014.

"Geographic Variation in Commercial Medical-Care Expenditures: A Framework for Decomposing Price and Utilization" (with Adam Hale Shapiro and Eli Liebman). *Journal of Health Economics*, 32(6): 1153–1165, 2013.

"Medical Care Price Indexes for Patients with Employer-Provided Insurance: Nationally Representative Estimates from MarketScan Data" (with Eli Liebman, Sarah Pack, and Adam Hale Shapiro). *Health Services Research*, 48(3): 1173–1190, 2013.

"Drug Innovations and Welfare Measures Computed from Market Demand: The Case of Anti-Cholesterol Drugs." *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 4(3): 167–189, 2012.

"The Value of Coverage in the Medicare Advantage Insurance Market." *Journal of Health Economics*, 29(6): 839–855, 2010.

"Do Low-Quality Products Affect High-Quality Entry? Multiproduct Firms and Nonstop Entry in Airline Markets." *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, 26(5): 1074–1089, 2008.

Book Chapters

"Off to the Races: A Comparison of Machine Learning and Alternative Data for Predicting Economic Indicators" (with Jeffrey C. Chen, Kyle Hood, Alexander Driessen, and Andrea Batch). In K. G. Abraham, R. S. Jarmin, B. C. Moyer, and M. D. Shapiro (eds.), *Big Data for Twenty-First-Century Economic Statistics*, 373–402. University of Chicago Press (NBER), 2022.

"Quantifying Productivity Growth in the Delivery of Important Episodes of Care within the Medicare Program Using Insurance Claims and Administrative Data" (with John A. Romley, Dana Goldman, and Neeraj Sood). In K. G. Abraham, R. S. Jarmin, B. C. Moyer, and M. D. Shapiro (eds.), *Big Data for Twenty-First-Century Economic Statistics*, 297–338. University of Chicago Press (NBER), 2022.

"Decomposing Medical Care Expenditure Growth" (with Eli Liebman and Adam Hale Shapiro). In A. Aizcorbe, C. Baker, E. R. Berndt, and D. M. Cutler (eds.), *Measuring and Modeling Health Care Costs*, 81–111. University of Chicago Press (NBER), 2018.

"Developing a Framework for Decomposing Medical-Care Expenditure Growth: Exploring Issues of Representativeness" (with Eli Liebman and Adam Hale Shapiro). In D. W. Jorgenson, J. S. Landefeld, and P. Schreyer (eds.), *Measuring Economic Sustainability and Progress*, 545–574. University of Chicago Press (NBER), 2014.

Other Publications

"Why Are Prescription Drug Prices Falling?" (with Benedic Ippolito). *Health Affairs Forefront*, forthcoming.

"Measuring the Gross Domestic Product (GDP): The Ultimate Data Science Project" (with Brian C. Moyer). *Harvard Data Science Review*, 2(1), 2020.

"Medical Expenditures Are Likely 'Worth It.' But Can We Measure How Much They Are Worth?" (with Lasanthi Fernando). *Health Affairs Blog* (now Forefront), February 20, 2019.

"Introducing the New BEA Health Care Satellite Account" (with Lindsey Rittmueller and Bryn Whitmire). *Survey of Current Business*, 95(1): 1–21, 2015.

WORKING PAPERS

"How Much Are Medical Innovations Worth? A Detailed Analysis Using Thousands of Cost-Effectiveness Studies" (with Lasanthi Fernando and Eli Liebman). **Revision requested, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics***. BEA Working Paper WP2024-8.

"Are Medicaid and Medicare Patients Treated Equally?" (with Calvin Ackley, Eli Liebman, and Adam Hale Shapiro). **Conditionally accepted, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy***. FRBSF Working Paper 2024-14.

"Quantifying Productivity Growth in Medical Care: 20 Years of Evidence from Nine Health Conditions" (with Calvin Ackley and John A. Romley). BEA Working Paper WP2026-5, 2026.

"Productivity Growth in the U.S. Medical Care Sector: An Analysis Using the U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis' Health Care Expenditure Statistics by Condition" (with Calvin Ackley, Eli Liebman, and John A. Romley). BEA Working Paper WP2026-11, 2026.

"Expanding the Frontier of Economic Measurement: Weekly Regional Employment Statistics" (with Matthew Bell, Eric English, Kyle Hood, Steven Mance, Lowell Mason, Brian Quistorff, and Michael Stepner). Working paper, 2026.

"Quality of Consumption" (with Benjamin Bridgman and Mahsa Gholizadeh). Working paper, 2026.

"Containing Consumption Zones" (with Andrea Batch, Daniel Fernandez, Mahsa Gholizadeh, Samuel Stern, and Steven Weinberg). Working paper, 2026.

Earlier Working Papers

"Spending by Condition for the Long-Term Care Population Using Medicaid Claims" (with Peter Shieh, Lasanthi Fernando, and Charles Roehrig). BEA Working Paper WP2020-10, 2020.

"Productivity Growth in Treating a Major Chronic Health Condition" (with John A. Romley, Dana Goldman, and Neeraj Sood). Hutchins Center Working Paper 61, Brookings Institution, 2020.

"Measuring the Effects of the COVID-19 Pandemic on Consumer Spending Using Card Transaction Data" (with Kyle Hood and Alexander Driessen). BEA Working Paper WP2020-5, 2020.

CURRENT MANAGEMENT RESPONSIBILITIES

- Manage staff and projects in health care measurement and economic research, including the development and annual production of BEA's Health Care Satellite Account, which uses claims for millions of enrollees and billions of claims to estimate spending by disease.
- Manage staff and projects on big data, including research and measurement using card transaction and payroll employment data, and the regular production of near-real-time card spending statistics published weekly on BEA's website.
- Manage BEA's collaboration with Opportunity Insights, the Harvard-based research group led by Raj Chetty.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Editor, *Forum for Health Economics & Policy* 2018–present

Referee: Econometrica, Journal of Political Economy, American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Journal of Health Economics, Health Services Research, Health Affairs, Health Economics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Law and Economics, International Journal of Industrial Organization, Applied Economics, European Journal of Health Economics, Canadian Journal of Economics, Forum for Health Economics & Policy, PLOS ONE, BMJ Global Health, International Journal of the Economics of Business

HONORS AND AWARDS

Department of Commerce Silver Award 2024

For advancing health care measurement by removing prescription drug rebates from the Health Care Satellite Account and producing new estimates that map BEA health statistics into the National Health Expenditure Accounts framework.

Department of Commerce Gold Award 2021

For rapidly responding to the COVID-19 pandemic by developing new ways to analyze and measure record-setting disruptions to the U.S. economy.

Department of Commerce Gold Award 2015

For innovation and technical achievement using commercial and administrative big data, leading to the first-ever set of estimates of spending and price changes by disease.

BEA Landefeld Innovation Award 2014

For ground-breaking work on measuring health care expenditures.

Best Empirical Work by a Staff Economist, DOJ Antitrust Division 2007–08

Best Empirical Work by a Staff Economist, DOJ Antitrust Division 2006–07